全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 38 單元 | 材料與物品 · Materials & Objects

Inside My Grandfather's Hardware Shop

走進爺爺的五金行

My grandfather's hardware shop sits at the corner of a narrow lane in Sanchong, between a breakfast stand and a temple. From the outside, it looks like a dark cave filled with dirt and old boxes. Inside, however, every object has its place, and Grandpa can find any of them with his eyes closed.

The walls are covered with hooks, and from each hook hangs something different: coils of copper wire, rubber hoses, elastic cords, and chains of every thickness. Along the left side stand barrels of nails and screws, sorted by size into plastic containers with hand-written labels. On the shelves above them sit jars of brass clips, boxes of drill bits, and a few bags of cement and clay that the neighbors buy for small repairs. Near the counter, Grandpa keeps his most expensive equipment: electric drills, a small crane for lifting engines, and a cutting machine that throws out sparks like tiny flames.

What I love most are the strange things that no one seems to buy. There is an old wooden bow with three arrows, an ax with a cracked handle, a walking cane made of bamboo, and a glass jar of crystal beads that Grandma used to make bracelets. Grandpa says every piece has a story. The bow, for instance, belonged to a customer who could not pay his bill in 1985, so he left it as a gift instead.

People often ask why Grandpa does not sell the shop, since the land is worth a lot of money now. He always gives the same answer. "A hardware shop is like a doctor's office," he says, wiping his hands on an oily cloth. "When something breaks at midnight, people need to know where to go." Then he hands me a booklet of prices, and I go back to counting screws.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
hardware	*n.*	五金；硬體	You can buy nails and locks at the hardware store. 你可以在五金行買釘子和鎖。

hook	*n.*	掛鉤	Hang your coat on the hook behind the door. 把你的外套掛在門後的掛鉤上。
copper	*n.*	銅	Copper is used in many electric wires. 銅被用在許多電線裡。
elastic	*adj.*	有彈性的	The waist of these pants is elastic. 這條褲子的腰是有彈性的。
barrel	*n.*	桶	The farmer stored rainwater in a big barrel. 農夫把雨水儲存在一個大桶裡。
container	*n.*	容器	Put the leftovers in a plastic container. 把剩菜放進塑膠容器裡。
cement	*n.*	水泥	The workers mixed cement to build the wall. 工人攪拌水泥來砌牆。
equipment	*n.*	設備；裝備	The school bought new equipment for the science lab. 學校為科學實驗室買了新設備。
crane	*n.*	起重機	A crane lifted the heavy steel beams onto the roof. 一台起重機把沉重的鋼樑吊到屋頂上。
cloth	*n.*	布	Wipe the table with a wet cloth. 用濕布擦桌子。

片語 Phrases

be covered with	被……覆蓋；布滿	The ground was covered with fallen leaves. 地上布滿了落葉。
for instance	例如	Some tools, for instance drills, are dangerous for children. 有些工具，例如電鑽，對兒童是危險的。
be worth	值……	This old coin is worth a lot of money. 這枚舊硬幣值很多錢。

文法與句型 Grammar

地方副詞片語＋V＋S（地方副詞倒裝句）

把表示地點的介系詞片語放在句首時，主詞和動詞要倒裝，常用於描寫景物。文中 from each hook hangs something different、Along the left side stand barrels ... 都是這種倒裝。

On the table lies an old map.

桌上放著一張舊地圖。

S＋V ..., since＋S＋V（since 表示「因為」）

since 除了「自從」，也可以當「因為」，用來說明大家已知的理由。文中 since the land is worth a lot of money now 說明為什麼大家問爺爺為何不賣店。

Since it was late, we took a taxi home.

因為時間很晚了，我們搭計程車回家。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。